

DAY 9

Daily Standup & Sprint Tracking

Learning Objectives:

- Understand the purpose and format of the Daily Standup
- Learn what a PM watches for during a sprint: blockers, scope creep, velocity drift
- Understand the burndown chart and how to read it
- Learn how to update and maintain a Jira board during an active sprint
- **YouTube Search Terms:**
 - "Daily standup meeting best practices"
 - "How to run a daily scrum standup"
 - "Sprint burndown chart explained"
 - "Jira sprint board tutorial"
- **Recommended Channels:**
 - Atlassian
 - Agile Alliance
 - [ProjectManager.com](https://www.projectmanager.com)

Tasks:

- Study the **three standup questions** — **What did I do yesterday? What will I do today? What is blocking me?** — understand why the standup is time-boxed to 15 minutes and why detailed problem-solving must never happen inside it
- Learn the **anti-patterns of standups** — status reporting to the PM instead of team sync, going over 15 minutes, not talking about blockers honestly — write a note on how you as a PM would address each anti-pattern
- Study the **burndown chart** — understand the **ideal burndown line vs the actual line**, what it means when the actual line is above the ideal (behind schedule), below it (ahead), or flat (no progress)
- Write **5 simulated daily standup logs** for your Expense Tracker team — each log should have 3 team members, their 3 answers each, identified blockers, and PM actions taken in response to those blockers
- Update your **Jira Sprint 1 board** — move 3 stories to In Progress, mark 1 as blocked, and add a comment to the blocked story explaining what the blocker is

Deliverable

- 5 simulated standup logs with PM actions
- Jira board screenshot showing updated sprint progress
- Short note: what the burndown chart tells you that the board does not

→ Daily Standup Overview

A Daily Standup (Daily Scrum) is a short 15-minute meeting held every day during a sprint. Its purpose is to help team members synchronize their work, identify blockers, and ensure progress toward the Sprint Goal.

Three Standup Questions

Question	Purpose
What did I do yesterday?	Share completed work
What will I do today?	Communicate planned work
What is blocking me?	Identify obstacles quickly

Why is it Time-Boxed to 15 Minutes?

- Keeps discussion focused.
- Encourages concise updates.
- Prevents unnecessary meetings.
- Allows developers to return quickly to work.
- Detailed problem-solving is discussed separately after the standup.

→ Standup Anti-Patterns & PM Response

Anti-Pattern	Problem	PM Action
Team members report status only to PM	Team loses collaboration focus	Remind everyone to speak to the team, not the PM
Standup exceeds 15 minutes	Wastes time and reduces effectiveness	Park detailed discussions for a follow-up meeting
Team hides blockers	Issues remain unresolved and delay sprint progress	Create a safe environment where blockers can be openly discussed
Team discusses technical solutions during standup	Meeting becomes too long	Schedule a separate technical discussion immediately afterward
Team members come unprepared	Updates become vague and unhelpful	Encourage preparation before the meeting

→Burndown Chart Notes

Ideal Burndown Line

Represents the expected rate of work completion throughout the sprint.

Actual Burndown Line

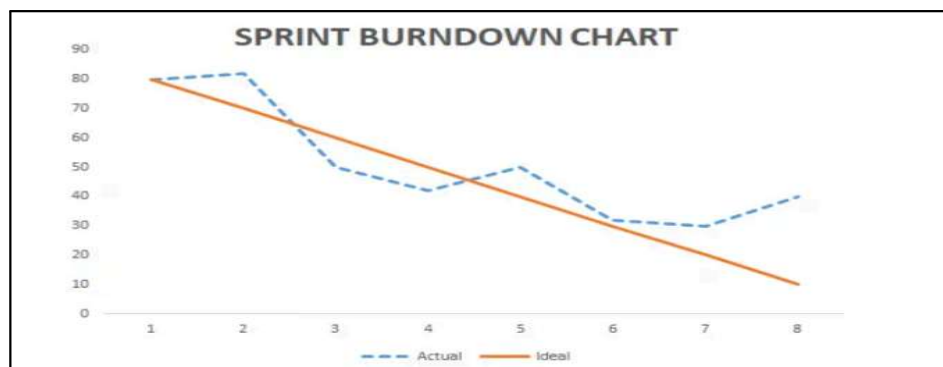
Shows the real progress of the team.

Situation	Meaning
Actual line above ideal line	Team is behind schedule
Actual line below ideal line	Team is ahead of schedule
Actual line matches ideal line	Sprint is progressing as planned
Actual line remains flat	No work is being completed

Example

Day	Ideal Remaining Points	Actual Remaining Points
1	40	40
3	32	36
5	24	28
7	16	18
10	0	0

The team starts behind schedule but recovers before sprint completion.



→ Simulated Daily Standup Logs

☐☐☐ Standup Log 1

Aayush (Frontend Developer)

- Yesterday: Completed Login UI.
- Today: Start Dashboard UI.
- Blocker: None.

Sneha (Backend Developer)

- Yesterday: Created Authentication API.
- Today: Integrate JWT authentication.
- Blocker: Waiting for database credentials.

Hardik (QA Engineer)

- Yesterday: Prepared Login test cases.
- Today: Execute authentication tests.
- Blocker: API not available yet.

Identified Blockers

- Missing database credentials.
- QA waiting for API completion.

PM Actions

- Contact DevOps team for database access.
- Coordinate frontend-backend integration timeline.

☐☐☐ Standup Log 2

Aayush

- Yesterday: Completed Dashboard UI.
- Today: Begin Expense Entry screen.
- Blocker: None.

Sneha

- Yesterday: JWT implementation completed.
- Today: Create Expense API.
- Blocker: None.

Hardik

- Yesterday: Tested Login feature.
- Today: Log defects.
- Blocker: Found authentication bug.

Identified Blockers

- Authentication defect.

PM Actions

- Prioritize bug fix.
- Assign issue to backend developer.

☐ Standup Log 3

Aayush

- Yesterday: Expense Entry screen completed.
- Today: Expense List page.
- Blocker: Awaiting API endpoint details.

Sneha

- Yesterday: Expense API completed.
- Today: Category API development.
- Blocker: None.

Hardik

- Yesterday: Tested Expense API.
- Today: Regression testing.
- Blocker: None.

Identified Blockers

- Frontend missing API specifications.

PM Actions

- Arrange quick sync between frontend and backend teams.
- Update API documentation.

☐☐☐ Standup Log 4

Aayush

- Yesterday: Expense List page completed.
- Today: Start Reports page.
- Blocker: None.

Sneha

- Yesterday: Category API completed.
- Today: Bug fixing.
- Blocker: Production-like test database unavailable.

Hardik

- Yesterday: Regression testing completed.
- Today: Reports module test planning.
- Blocker: Waiting for Reports page.

Identified Blockers

- Test database unavailable.

PM Actions

- Escalate infrastructure request.
- Track resolution with DevOps.

☐☐☐ Standup Log 5

Aayush

- Yesterday: Reports page completed.
- Today: UI refinements.
- Blocker: None.

Sneha

- Yesterday: Fixed reported bugs.
- Today: Final integration support.
- Blocker: None.

Hardik

- Yesterday: Reports testing completed.
- Today: Final sprint validation.
- Blocker: None.

Identified Blockers

- No blockers.

PM Actions

- Monitor sprint completion.
 - Prepare Sprint Review demonstration.
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→Jira Sprint 1 Board Update

Stories Moved to In Progress

Story ID	Story
US-01	User Registration
US-02	User Login
US-03	Add Expense

Story Marked Blocked

Story ID	Story
US-04	Expense Categories

Comment Added to Blocked Story

Blocked: Backend team is waiting for database credentials from DevOps before category tables can be created. Estimated resolution within 1 day.

→What the Burndown Chart Tells You That the Board Does Not

The Jira board shows the current status of individual stories, such as To Do, In Progress, or Done. However, it does not clearly show whether the team is on track to finish the sprint on time. The burndown chart provides a visual representation of remaining work over time and helps identify trends such as falling behind schedule, moving ahead of schedule, or periods with no progress. A PM can use the burndown chart to predict sprint outcomes early and take corrective action before deadlines are missed.

Additionally, the burndown chart helps measure team productivity throughout the sprint. It can reveal bottlenecks, recurring blockers, or sudden increases in workload. The chart also helps stakeholders quickly understand sprint health without reviewing every task individually. By comparing actual progress with the ideal trend line, the PM can make better decisions about priorities and resource allocation. Overall, the burndown chart provides a high-level view of sprint performance that complements the detailed information shown on the Jira board.